



TRUSTFORCE ADVISORS RESOURCE GUIDE

Veteran Fiduciary Support Guide

Helping Veterans and Families Navigate Fiduciary Responsibilities

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Purpose: This guide helps veterans, families, caregivers, and fiduciaries understand the importance of organized support when VA benefits or other veteran-related funds are being managed by another person. ---

Section 1: What Is a VA Fiduciary?

A VA fiduciary is a person or organization appointed to manage VA benefits for a beneficiary who is unable to manage those funds independently.

The fiduciary's role is to use the funds for the veteran or beneficiary's needs, maintain accurate records, and act in the beneficiary's best interest.

Section 2: Fiduciary Responsibilities

A veteran fiduciary may be responsible for

- ☐ Receiving VA funds
- ☐ Paying housing expenses
- ☐ Paying utilities

- ☐ Paying medical or care expenses
- ☐ Managing personal needs funds
- ☐ Protecting unused funds
- ☐ Keeping receipts
- ☐ Maintaining bank records
- ☐ Preparing reports if requested
- ☐ Communicating with VA representatives
- ☐ Protecting the veteran from exploitation

Section 3: Important Veteran Fiduciary Documents

Keep copies of

- ☐ VA fiduciary appointment letter
- ☐ VA benefit award letters
- ☐ Monthly benefit statements
- ☐ Bank statements
- ☐ Receipts
- ☐ Lease or mortgage records
- ☐ Utility bills
- ☐ Insurance records
- ☐ Medical expense records
- ☐ Caregiver agreements
- ☐ Burial or funeral information, if known
- ☐ Contact information for VA offices

Section 4: Monthly Veteran Fiduciary Checklist

- ☐ Confirm VA payment received
- ☐ Pay housing expense
- ☐ Pay utilities
- ☐ Pay insurance
- ☐ Pay care expenses
- ☐ Provide personal needs money, if appropriate
- ☐ Save receipts
- ☐ Update transaction log
- ☐ Review bank balance
- ☐ Watch for fraud or scams
- ☐ Document veteran needs

- ☐ Communicate with family or care team, when appropriate

Section 5: Veteran Needs Review

Each month, review

- Is the veteran's housing stable?
- Are utilities current?
- Are medical needs being met?
- Are medications being obtained?
- Are there transportation needs?
- Are there food or clothing needs?
- Is the veteran being financially exploited?
- Are there unpaid bills?
- Are benefits being used for the veteran's care?

Section 6: Working With Family Members

Family communication can prevent confusion and disputes.

Recommended practices

- Keep communication respectful
- Share general updates when appropriate
- Do not disclose sensitive information unnecessarily
- Document disagreements
- Avoid verbal-only financial decisions
- Keep receipts and records
- Refer legal disputes to an attorney

Section 7: Annual Review Preparation

Prepare

- ☐ 12 months of bank statements
- ☐ Income summary
- ☐ Expense summary
- ☐ Receipts
- ☐ Housing expense records
- ☐ Care expense records
- ☐ Insurance documents
- ☐ Updated budget
- ☐ Explanation for unusual expenses
- ☐ Contact updates

Section 8: Veteran Protection Red Flags

Watch for

- Family members asking for money
- New “friends” requesting access
- Sudden withdrawals
- Unpaid bills despite available funds
- Missing debit cards
- Pressure to transfer money
- Suspicious online relationships
- Repeated cash withdrawals
- Changes in housing stability

Need Help Managing Fiduciary Responsibilities?

TrustForce Advisors provides professional support for conservators, guardians, trustees, veteran fiduciaries, families and caregivers, attorneys, and professionals.

Schedule a consultation today.

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